A CREATIVE PROPOSAL · PRIVATE AND CONFIDENTIAL

TC MC THRIFTY



A character, a voice and a website with ten looks, a stack of playable modules and a collectible card pack.

PREPARED BY THE STUDIO FOR THE CLIENT · OCTOBER 2026

THE PLAN

WHAT WE ARE SHOWING YOU

01
The idea
The challenge, the big idea and who it is for.

02
The character
The mascot, the voice and the brand system.

03
Ten site looks
One idea dressed ten different ways.

04
Modules and the Holo Pack
Playable extras people will share.

Every screenshot in this deck comes from the live preview pages, not from mockups.

THE CHALLENGE

EVERYONE LOVES A DEAL. NOBODY LOVES READING ABOUT ONE.

Deal sites are lists of links. We want people to come back for the host, then stay for the savings.

THE BIG IDEA

NO FULL PRICE. EVER.

Minnesota's premier anonymous cheapskate squeezes every penny out of the Twin Cities (and beyond) so you do not have to. Saving money becomes a game you win with a friend who is slightly too proud of it.

THE CHARACTER



BREAKFAST SANDWICH HEAD. GOLD CHAINS. ZERO FULL-PRICE ITEMS.

- Vintage Minnesota layers: plaid flannel, a ball cap, coupons in hand.
- Dollar signs, price tags and a cockatiel sidekick in every scene.
- The Twin Cities skyline behind him, so it always feels local.
- Anonymous by design. No names, no

THE VOICE

DRY. DEADPAN. ONE REAL TIP IN EVERY JOKE.

He says: "The second cup is for later. Put it in the fridge. Cold coffee is a personality, not a problem."

He says: "Go Sunday, not Saturday. Day two is when firm prices get negotiable and the owl starts looking like a bargain."

The joke gets the click. The tip earns the return visit.

WHO IT IS FOR

THREE KINDS OF DEAL HUNTERS

The Thrifter

Estate sales, bin stores, fill-a-bag days. Wants to know where to go and when.

The Coupon Stacker

Apps, game pieces, rewards. Wants the trick that saves the next five dollars.

The Fare Chaser

Error fares and cheap flights. Wants a heads up before the deal disappears.

What they share: they enjoy the hunt almost as much as the savings.

THE BRAND SYSTEM

A COUPON BOOK ON A ZINE PHOTOCOPIER

Paper | Ink | Mustard | Hunter | Orange | Tag red | Sky | Paper 2

ANTON

Big condensed headlines, like a front page.

Newsreader

A newsletter serif for deal headlines.

PRESS START

Eight-bit labels for scores and counters.

Every color comes straight from the mascot art. Black outlines, hard shadows, price tags and a little tilt on everything.

ONE IDEA, TEN LOOKS

THE WHOLE LINEUP



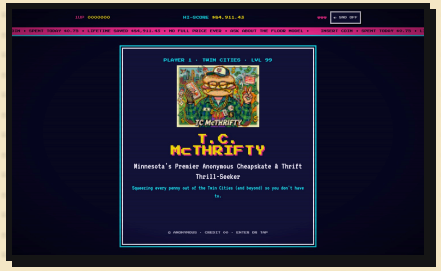
A · The zine coupon book



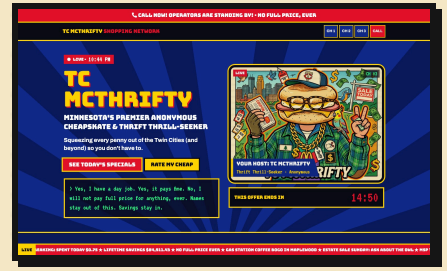
B · The weekly newsletter



C · Loud stickers on dark ink



D · The 8-bit arcade



E · The late-night shopping channel



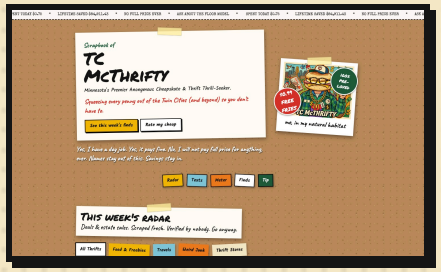
F · The park ranger field guide



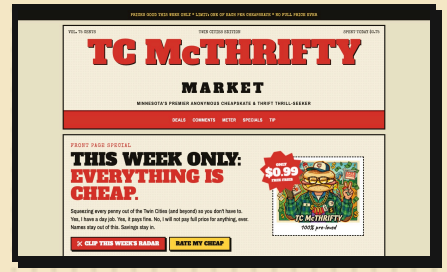
G · The luxury fashion magazine



H · The retro computer desktop



I · The handmade scrapbook



J · The weekly grocery ad

LOOK A OF 10

THE ZINE COUPON BOOK

The mascot leads. A bold stacked title, a taped note, stickers on the art and a coupon-card feed.

Best when the character is the star.





LOOK B OF 10

THE WEEKLY NEWSLETTER

A giant condensed masthead, a dated issue box, a lead story and big editorial headings.

Best when the weekly Radar is the star.





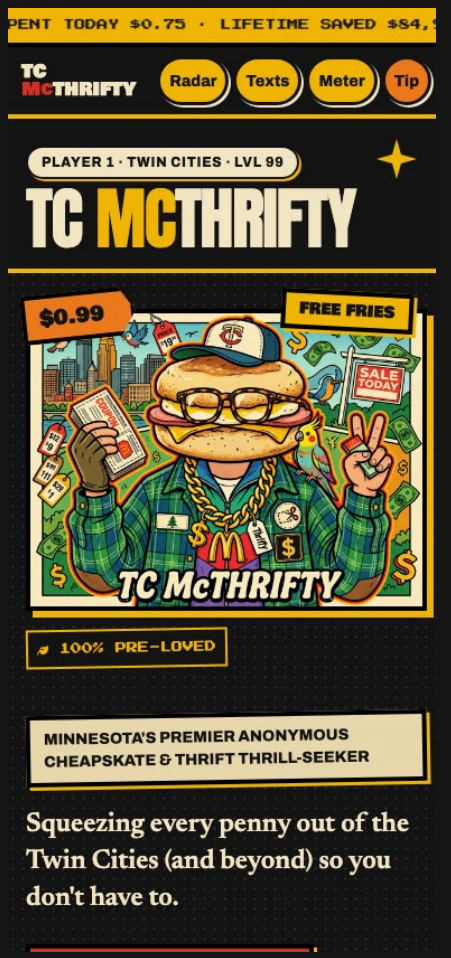
LOOK C OF 10

LOUD STICKERS ON DARK INK

Pill stickers with small offset shadows, doodle sparkles and one huge savings number on black.

Best for social sharing and screenshots.





LOOK D OF 10

THE 8-BIT ARCADE

Press start. The whole site is a game menu, and the Radar becomes a high-score table.

Best for a playful, return-for-the-score crowd.



LOOK E OF 10

THE LATE-NIGHT SHOPPING CHANNEL

Call now banners, a live ticker, a countdown clock and a host lower-third.

Best for big, funny first impressions.



LOOK F OF 10

THE PARK RANGER FIELD GUIDE

Sections are trail markers on a map. Every deal is a sighting.

Best for the outdoorsy, Minnesota-proud reader.



LOOK G OF 10

THE LUXURY FASHION MAGAZINE

The $3 Collection. Huge serif type, white space and a glossy editorial feel.

Best for a surprise that makes thrifting look chic.



LOOK H OF 10

THE RETRO COMPUTER DESKTOP

Folders and windows you click open: Radar.exe, Texts.txt, Meter.app.

Best for people who like to poke around.

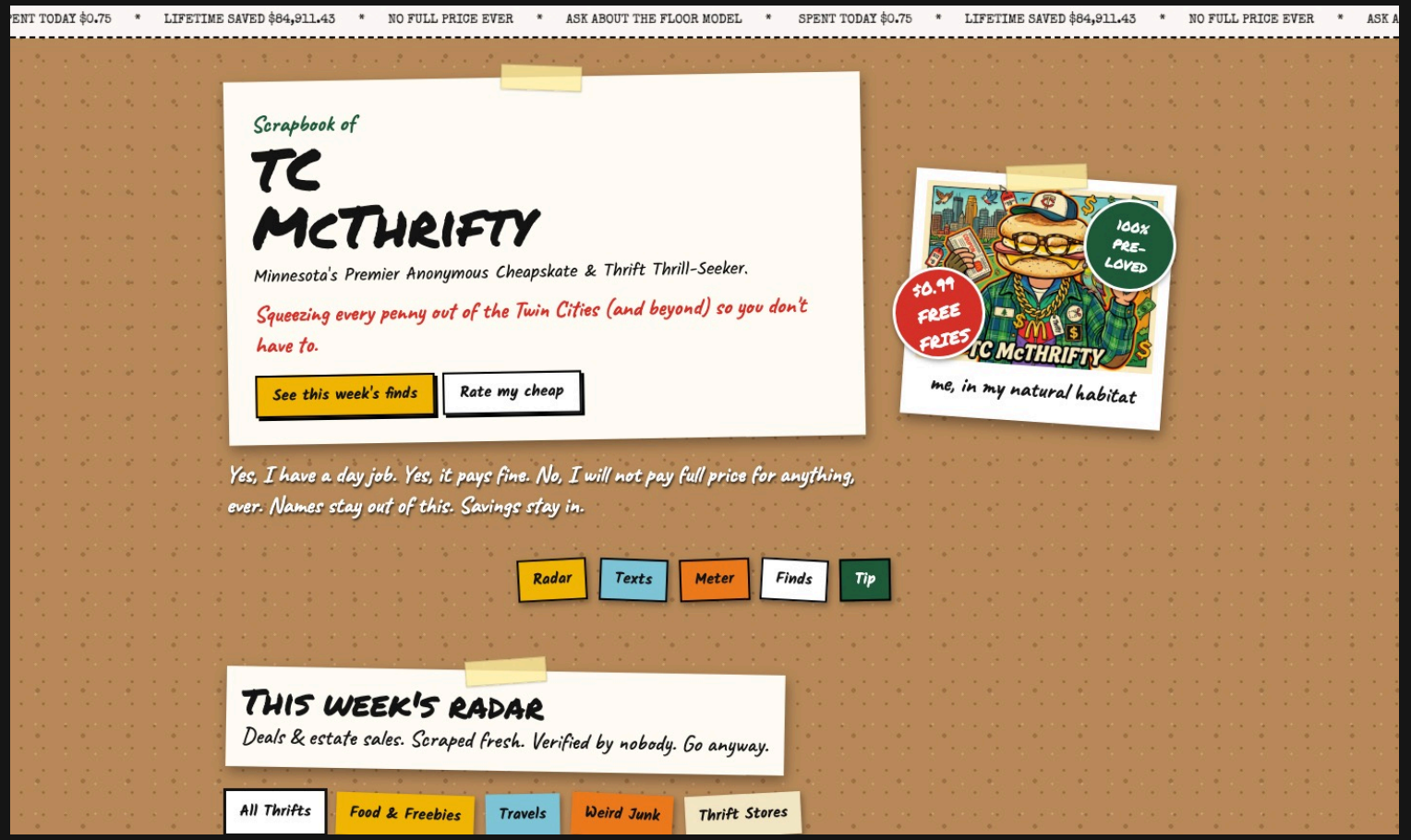


LOOK 1 OF 10

THE HANDMADE SCRAPBOOK

A cork board with tape, polaroids, handwritten notes and stickers.

Best for warmth and personality.

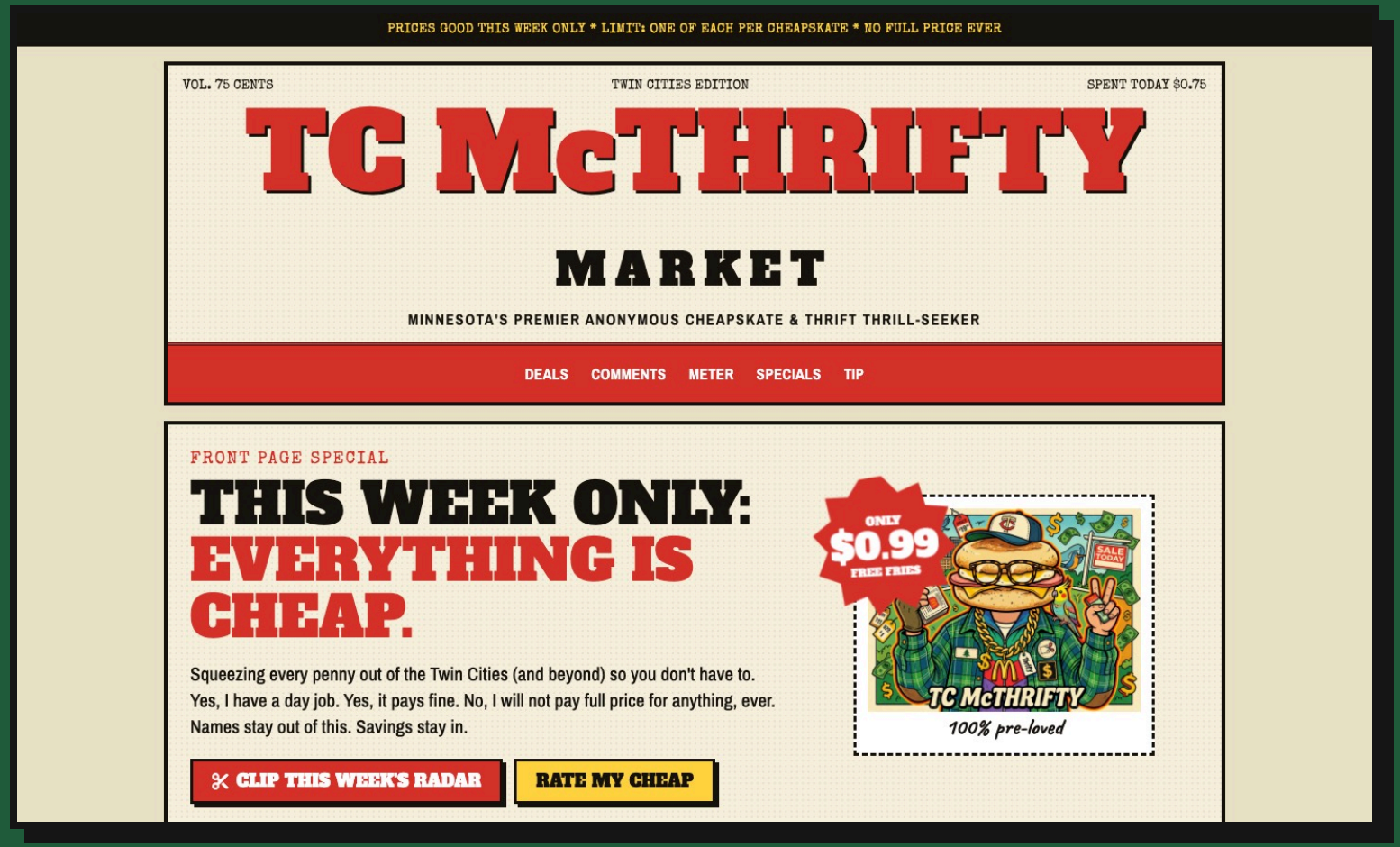


LOOK J OF 10

THE WEEKLY GROCERY AD

A newspaper insert with red price bursts, coupon dotted lines and THIS WEEK ONLY.

Best for making a deal feed feel instantly familiar.

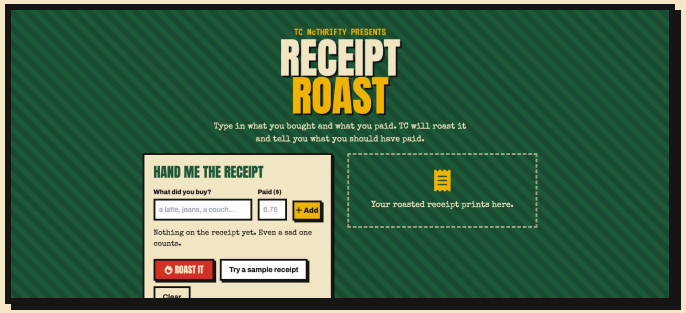


BEYOND THE SITE

TEN PLAYABLE MODULES

Small, funny, shareable toys that each give one real money tip. Each one is a single page and works on a phone.

MODULES 1 TO 6



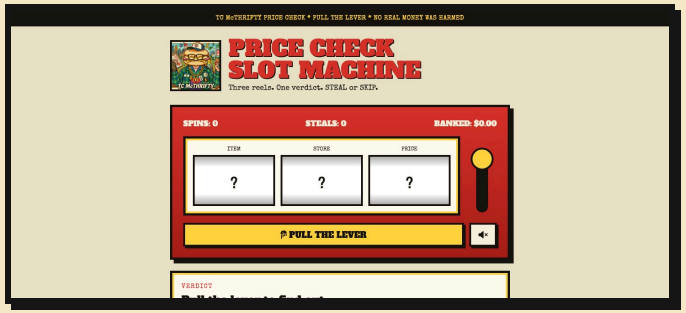
Receipt Roast

Type what you bought and what you paid. TC roasts it and shows what you should have paid.



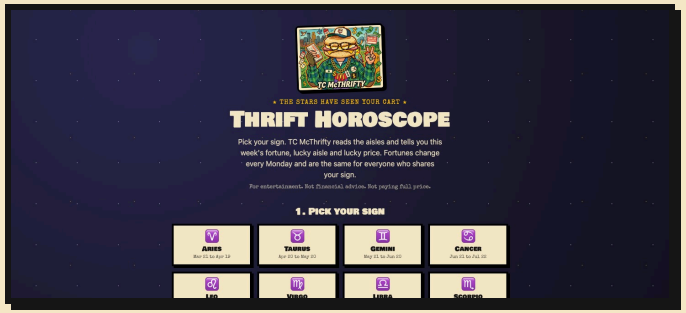
Estate Sale Bingo

A five by five card of estate sale sightings. Tap to mark, then BINGO.



Price Check Slot Machine

Pull the lever. Three reels land on an item, a store and a price. STEAL or SKIP.



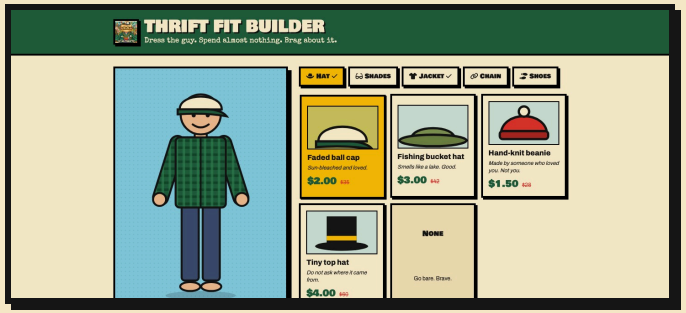
Thrift Horoscope

Pick your sign for this week's thrift fortune, lucky aisle and lucky price.



Haggle Simulator

Three rounds of haggling with a stubborn estate sale seller. Win or walk.



Thrift Fit Builder

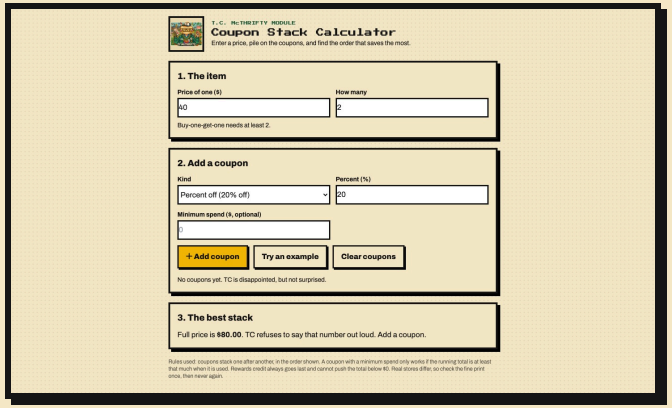
Build an outfit out of thrift finds.

MODULES 7 TO 9



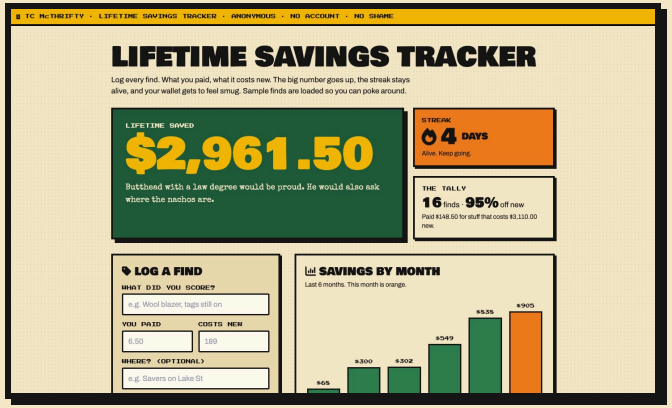
Twin Cities Steal Map

A map of steals around the Twin Cities.



Coupon Stack Calculator

Stack your coupons and watch the total fall.

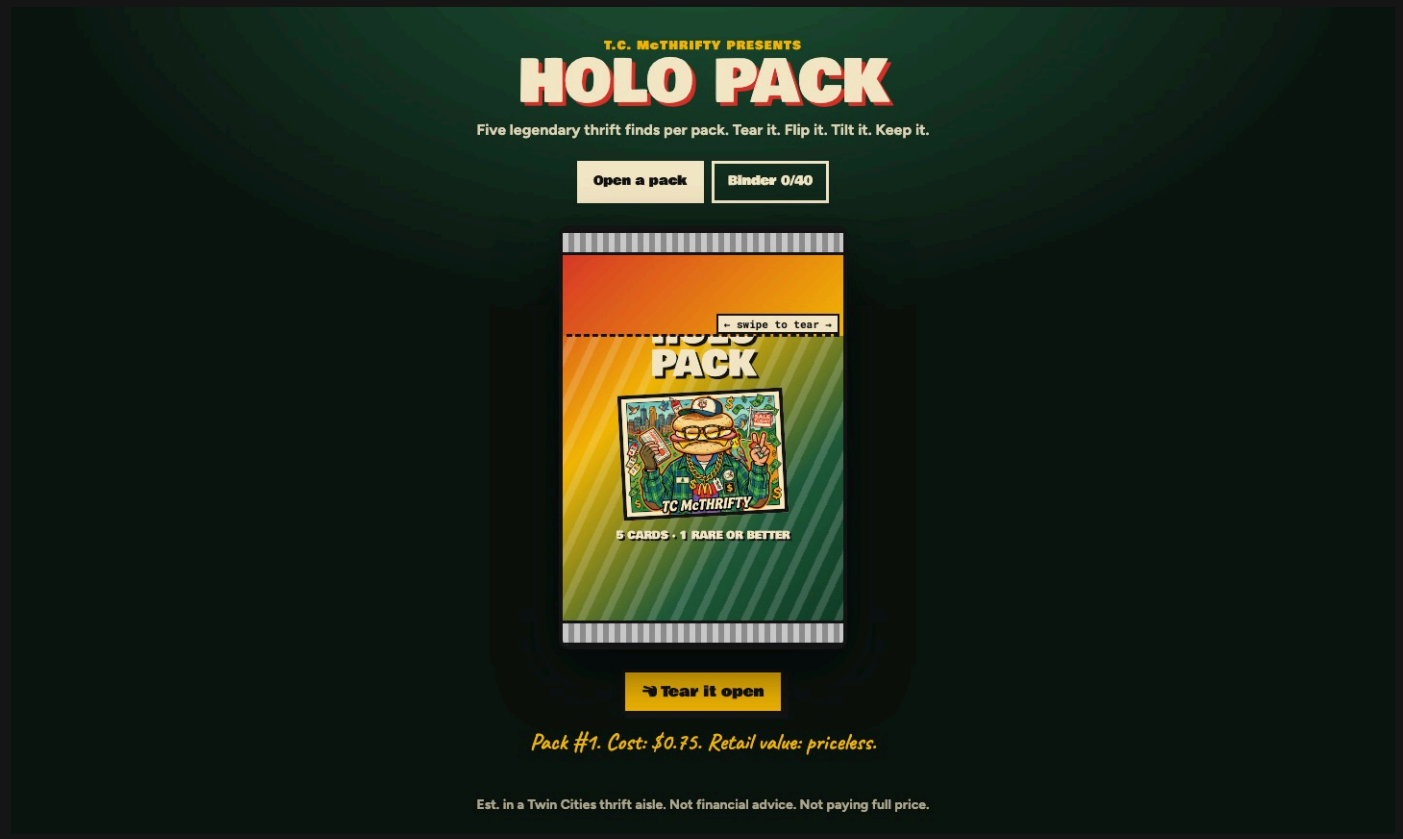


Lifetime Savings Tracker

The running savings total, kept like a scoreboard.

Every module is one page, works on a phone, and ends with a real money tip. Next up: the Holo Pack.

THE HOLO PACK

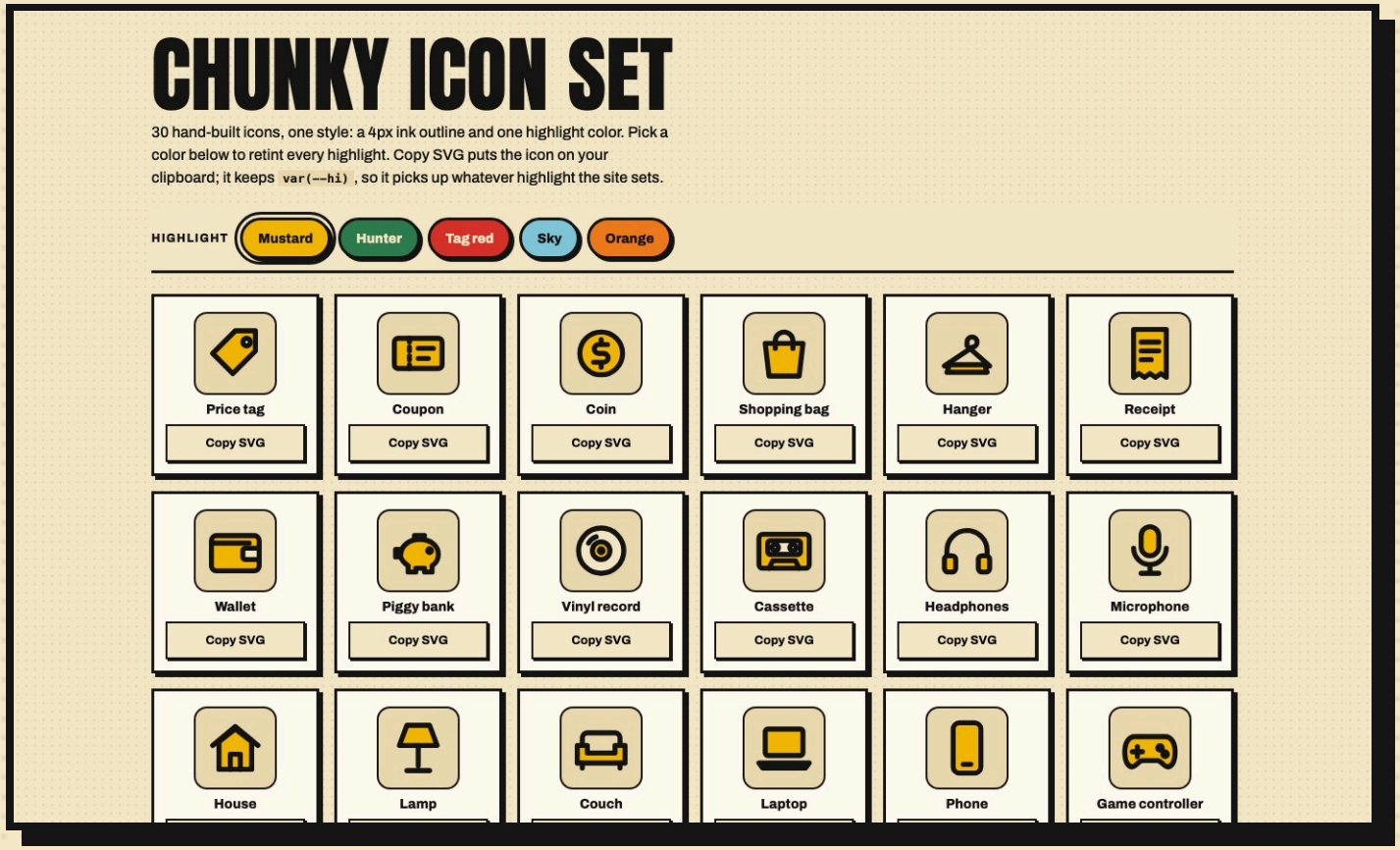


TEAR IT OPEN. FLIP IT. KEEP IT.

- Five legendary thrift finds in every pack, with at least one rare or better.
- A 40 card binder to fill, so people open one more pack.
- Pack #1 costs $0.75. Retail value: priceless.

CHUNKY ICON SET

A matching set of icons and stickers that every look can borrow, so the whole family feels like one brand.



OUR RECOMMENDATION

LEAD WITH B. BORROW FROM THE REST.

The home

Look B, the newsletter, gives a weekly reason to return and a place for the Radar to be the lead story.

The character

Keep A's coupon cards and C's stickers as small accents so the mascot stays the star.

The hooks

Launch with the Holo Pack and Receipt Roast. They are the most shareable toys we built.

This is our pick. The choice is yours, and any of the ten can go live.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

FROM PICK TO LAUNCH

1. Pick a direction

One look, or a blend. All ten are built and clickable now.

2. Real photos and a real issue

Haul photos replace the placeholders. We set an issue date and five fresh deals.

3. A weekly rhythm

Five deals, a tip and a new module or card pack on a steady schedule.

4. A safe public version

Look-alike swaps for real brand marks in the art before anything goes public.

SPENT TODAY: $0.75

NO FULL PRICE. EVER.

Thank you. Let's pick a look.